Changing requirements is one of the most frustrating things that a team needs to take in stride. I've been in many sprint retrospectives where teams complain about missing goals due to changing requirements, I've seen products make it out the door with a fraction of intended functionality because of indecision around requirements throughout the development of the product, and I've been a part of several development cycles where our work was scrapped because architectures, features, or experiences changed after we started.

When it comes to figuring out how well your team can handle changing requirements, you need to keep two things in perspective:

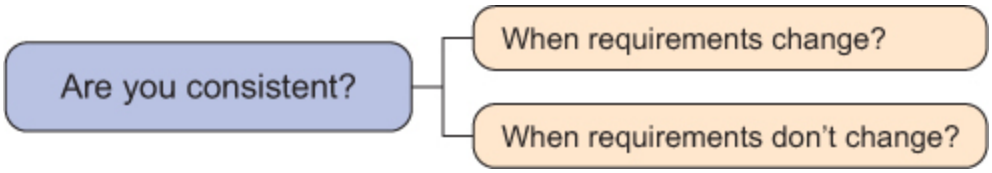
- How do you know if requirements are changing?
- Can your team maintain a consistent pace when requirements change?

For this you'd have to know your current metrics for consistency (for example, lead time, recidivism, and velocity) and you'd need to know when requirements are changing. With both of those in hand you can measure how consistently your team performs in the face of change.

10.5.1. Measuring effective requirements

I've mind mapped the final principle in figure 10.11.

Figure 10.11. Mapping out "Are you consistent?"



The interesting thing here is that you need to compare your consistency when requirements are static against when they change. To do that you need to measure your team's consistency and you need to track when requirements are in flux.